

Dual-SIM Android Trio

Samsung has launched the Galaxy Ace Duos, Galaxy Y Duos and Galaxy Y Pro Duos in India.
<http://bit.ly/wHMJMY>

What's Hot, with msnNOW

Microsoft has developed a new social and news reading application, called msnNOW, what's hot, and trending.
<http://bit.ly/xhyYlu>

Windows Phone 8 will be based on the NT Kernel

Despite the similar names, Windows Mobile / Windows Phone and the Windows we use on desktops don't share the same kernel. While the Linux kernel used in Android devices and the one used in desktops are quite similar, the same has not been true of Windows desktop and mobile OSs. Come Windows Phone 8 this will change.

For those who might not know this, the kernel is the very core of any operating system. It handles direct communication with the hardware, managing system resources such as CPU, RAM, and I/O devices. Applications built to run on one kernel will not run on another. Despite looking and behaving drastically different, Ubuntu Linux, Android and MeeGo at their very core use the Linux kernel.

It is possible for some applications written for MeeGo to run directly on Ubuntu, and vice-versa, although Android is a different story since its applications run on a VM.

Quite some details about Windows Phone 8 have been leaked via a video intended for internal distribution within

kernel from Windows 8, this essentially means that Windows Phone 8 and Windows 8 will be the same OS. By basing both operating systems on the same kernel, developers at Microsoft can share code for common features between the OSs. This would include code for sensors, networking, multimedia, etc.

So what does this mean for Windows Phone 7 apps, considering that Windows Phone 8 changes the architecture of the OS. Well, not much. Windows Phone 7 applications are not built on native code, so it is easy for them to be supported on Windows Phone 8. On the other hand, this might make it possible for developers to share more code between Windows 8 apps and Windows Phone 8 apps.

Of course, simply coming up with a new architecture won't attract any new users. Windows

Phone 8 will also come with a number of new features: Internet Explorer 10 for mobile will come in Windows Phone 8. Like Opera for desktop and mobile it will support server-side compression for lower bandwidth usage and faster internet access on mobile. A new technology called "Data Smart" that comes in Windows 8 and Windows Phone 8 optimises cellular data usage.

Skype, recently acquired by Microsoft, will be more tightly integrated into the system, but still a separate app. SkyDrive, Microsoft's cloud storage service will be integrated for sync across phone and desktop. New business features such as support for hardware-accelerated encryption - allowing businesses to distribute apps privately within the company. NFC support will also be available, for sharing content and payments.

Windows Phone 8 seems to be an exciting prospect indeed, although for now the new kernel seems to be the biggest revelation of all. 



Nokia. With Windows Phone 8 it seems Microsoft will finally unify their operating systems at the very core level. With Windows 8 already taking UI direction from Windows Phone, and Windows Phone taking the

Android menu button to be replaced by Action bar

Google is now recommending that Android app developers stop using the Menu button for their apps, instead, start using the Action Bar introduced in Honeycomb, and incorporated in Ice Cream Sandwich. A new section of the Android Design style guide has also been made, with recommendations on how developers should design their Action Bars.

The move is another step away from hardware buttons, a trend seen in Honeycomb tablets, and Ice Cream Sandwich devices,



which like the Galaxy Nexus, only feature Back, Home, and Recent Apps buttons - doing away with Menu, and Search buttons.

The change in design philosophy was announced on

the developer. android.com blog, with Scott Main, Lead Tech Writer, explaining that developers should move away from using to the menu button, toward the more intuitive and consistent action bar. "This isn't a new concept - the action bar pattern has been around on Android even before Honeycomb - but as Ice Cream Sandwich rolls out to more devices,

it's important that you begin to migrate your designs to the action bar in order to promote a consistent Android user experience."

Further ensuring a consistent user experience for the action bar, the Android UX Team has designed common action icons to use, such as Refresh, Delete, Attach, Star, Share and more. For more information, refer to the "Say Goodbye to the Menu Button" post, the Android Design's Action Bar style guide, and the Action Bar developer guide. 